

Sunday Roast Chicken

Serves 3 (+ next-day lunch) · roast chicken · anchovy spaghetti · bitter leaf salad · torched-sugar yogurt pots

MENU

Roast Chicken — Keller method, overnight dry-brine, breast-temp pull; two Huber's birds, one for dinner, one for next-day lunch

Anchovy Spaghetti — garlic, olive oil, lemon, doubled parsley; finished in the skillet

Bitter Leaf Salad — little gem, frisée, endive; lemon-Dijon vinaigrette

Torched-Sugar Yogurt Pots, Odette Jam — chilled yogurt over dark-fruit jam, brûléed sugar lid cracked at the table

SHARED PREP

Lemon: 1–2 lemons total — zest $\frac{1}{2}$ + $1\frac{1}{2}$ tsp juice → pasta; $1\frac{1}{2}$ tbsp juice → vinaigrette; reserve a wedge for the table

Parsley: 1 bunch — chop ~6 tbsp → pasta finish (doubled for freshness against the roast)

Garlic: 4 large cloves, minced → pasta only

Thyme: 2 tsp minced per bird → chicken pan (optional, Keller)

Dijon: 1 tbsp → vinaigrette

Shopping List

Ingredient	Total	Chicken	Pasta	Salad	Dessert
PROTEIN / MEAT					
Whole chicken, cage-free (Huber's, ~1.07 kg each)	2 birds	2 birds	—	—	—
Anchovy fillets, tinned	1 tin	—	6–8 fillets	—	—
PRODUCE					
Garlic (pantry check)	4 lg cloves	—	4 cloves	—	—
Lemons	1–2	—	zest $\frac{1}{2}$ + $1\frac{1}{2}$ tsp juice	$1\frac{1}{2}$ tbsp juice	—
Italian parsley	1 bunch	—	~6 tbsp	—	—
Thyme	small bunch	2 tsp/bird	—	—	—
Little gem	~2 heads	—	—	2 heads	—
Frisée	~ $\frac{1}{2}$ head	—	—	$\frac{1}{2}$ head	—
Endive (Belgian)	1–2 heads	—	—	accent	—
PANTRY / DRY					
Spaghetti (pantry check)	12 oz / 340 g	—	12 oz	—	—
Dijon mustard (pantry check)	1 tbsp	—	—	1 tbsp	—
FRIDGE / DAIRY					
Unsalted butter (pantry check)	small amount	carved meat	—	—	—
Greek yogurt, full-fat	350 g	—	—	—	350 g
OILS & LIQUIDS					
Olive oil (pantry check)	~4 tbsp	—	4 tbsp	—	—
Extra-virgin olive oil (pantry check)	~4 tbsp	—	—	4 tbsp	—
PANTRY / DESSERT					
Odette dark-fruit jam (have)	6 tsp	—	—	—	6 tsp
Caster sugar (pantry check, brûlée)	~3 tsp	—	—	—	~3 tsp
Honey or icing sugar (pantry check)	1–2 tsp	—	—	—	1–2 tsp
SEASONING					
Diamond Crystal kosher salt (pantry check)	brine + pinches	~18–20 g both birds	water (light)	1 pinch	—
Black pepper (pantry check)	to taste	skin	plating	to taste	—

Two Huber's birds (~1.07 kg each) — salt ~9–10 g per bird, ~18–20 g total; one carved for dinner, one for next-day lunch. One tin of anchovies covers the pasta with fillets to spare. One–two lemons cover pasta and vinaigrette. Salad uses extra-virgin for the vinaigrette; pasta can use regular olive oil. Dessert: Odette jam on hand; caster sugar and yogurt the only additions. No rice component in this meal.

Meal Workflow

Anchored to 8:00 PM service · chicken is the clock · pasta & salad built into the rest window · dessert assembled ahead, torched at service

T-MINUS TIMELINE

Time	Action
T-24 hr	Dry-brine both birds: ~9–10 g salt each, uncovered on racks in fridge with airflow (target 18–24 hr; 30 hr hard stop)
T-3 to 4 hr	Assemble dessert pots: jam base, sweetened yogurt over, level surface, chill (holds up to 4 hr; do NOT torch yet)
T-120	Pull both birds from fridge — temper on counter (full 60 min)
T-75	Preheat oven 450°F / 232°C
T-65	Pat both birds bone-dry, truss, pepper skin (no re-salt). Insert ThermoWorks leave-in probe into the breast of one bird — thickest part, off the bone; set high alarm ~150°F / 66°C
T-60	Both birds into oven on wire racks set over trays, side by side with a gap — roast to breast temp, ~40–55 min
T-30	Prep salad: wash and dry leaves, hold in fridge; whisk vinaigrette, set aside
T-20	Leave-in probe alarms near ~150°F. Spot-check the second bird's breast with the ThermoWorks (one probe watches one bird)
T-8	Birds out at breast temp — add thyme to pan, single baste. Rest uncovered (15 min; dinner bird carves at T-0, lunch bird cools for fridge)
T-8	Induction #1: pasta water on to boil (salted lightly). Induction #2: oil + garlic, low (2 min)
T-6	Add anchovies to garlic oil — cook to just-coloring garlic (~3 min), then off-heat (skillet stays as finishing pan)
T-6	Spaghetti into water — cook firm-tender (~9–10 min); reserve ¼ cup water before draining
T-3	Warm plates. Carve dinner bird; spoon a little warm pan juice over the breast (not the skin)
T-1	Transfer drained pasta into anchovy skillet — lemon juice + zest, splash of pasta water, emulsify off-heat, pepper
T-0	Dress salad, plate the three savoury dishes. Parsley over pasta; vinaigrette & pan juices beside the chicken
Dessert	After mains clear: sugar the chilled pots and torch to amber, one at a time; rest 1 min to set, serve (torch only at service)

If the plating window slips, pasta fails first — it clumps and its oil breaks as it cools; the dressed salad wilts second. The chicken tolerates the wait best, so plate it first. The dessert is decoupled — assembled hours ahead, torched only when the mains are done.

WORKFLOW NOTES

Critical path: The chicken governs — dry-brine → temper → roast both birds to breast temp (150–152°F / 66–67°C) → mandatory 15-min uncovered rest. Pasta and salad build inside that rest window; never hold the chicken for a side. Dessert is fully decoupled: assembled hours ahead, torched once the mains clear.

Oven & heat sequencing: Single oven state throughout — 450°F / 232°C, the two birds on wire racks over trays, side by side with a gap for airflow, no transitions. No pasta water until the birds are out resting, so oven and induction never contend. Induction #1 owns the pasta pot; Induction #2 owns the anchovy skillet, which doubles as the finishing pan (off-heat before pasta lands). The butane torch finishes the dessert at service. If the garlic races, pull it off-heat first — scorched garlic oil is unrecoverable.

Thermometers: ThermoWorks leave-in probe in one bird's breast (alarm ~150°F / 66°C) as the primary gate; ThermoWorks instant-read to spot-check the second bird. One leave-in probe watches one bird only.

HOLDING CHAIN

Component	Hold Strategy	Max Hold	Drift Risk	Corrective
Chicken (post-rest)	Uncovered on board, carved late	15 min ideal, 25 max	Skin softens if tented; meat cools	Do not tent. Carve just before serving. Past 20 min, warm plates
Anchovy oil base	Skillet off-heat, residual warm	10 min	Garlic bitters if re-heated	Hold off-heat; pasta finishes in it — no re-fry
Pasta (in skillet)	Do not hold	0 min	Clumps, oil dulls	Time drain to skillet being ready; emulsify and plate immediately
Salad leaves (undressed)	Fridge, dry, in bowl	60 min	Wilt if dressed early	Keep leaves and vinaigrette separate until T-0
Vinaigrette	Room temp, whisk before use	2 hr	Separates on standing	Re-whisk before dressing

Component	Hold Strategy	Max Hold	Drift Risk	Corrective
Dessert pots (un-torched)	Fridge, chilled, levelled	4 hr	Yogurt weeps if held too long	Pour off surface whey before sugaring
Torched crust	Torch to order	~10 min	Crust weeps on cold yogurt	Torch only at service, one at a time; serve within minutes

Roast Chicken

Serves 3 + next-day lunch · Two birds ~1.07 kg each (Huber's, 2.14 kg combined) · Total ~24 hr (mostly passive) · Active ~20 min · Temper 60 min · Roast ~40–55 min · Rest 15 min · Oven 450°F / 232°C

Keller's austere high-heat roast — crackling salted skin over juicy meat, no basting — with an overnight dry-brine and a breast-temperature pull for even seasoning and a reliably juicy breast. Two small birds roasted side by side; one carved for dinner, one for next-day lunch.

INGREDIENTS

Ingredient	Amount
Whole chicken, cage-free (Huber's)	2 birds, ~1.07 kg each (2.14 kg combined)
Diamond Crystal kosher salt	~9–10 g per bird (≈1 tbs), ~18–20 g total
Black pepper, freshly ground	to taste
Thyme, minced (optional)	2 tsp per bird
Unsalted butter	to slather on carved meat only

PREP PHASE

1. Dry-brine (both birds), T-24 hr. Pat each bird very dry, inside and out. Weigh ~9–10 g salt per bird; rain ~85% over the skin from height, the rest in the cavity. Set both breast-up on racks over trays, **uncovered**, in the fridge — target 18–24 hr, 30 hr hard stop. *Give each bird airflow — do not crowd or stack. Past 30 hr on a bird this small turns the texture ham-like.*

2. Temper, T-120. Counter, full 60 min, to take the chill off both. *A fridge-cold bird roasts unevenly and steams; small birds still want the full hour for an even centre.*

3. Final prep, T-65. Re-pat each skin bone-dry. Truss. Pepper the skin. **Do not re-salt** — the dry-brine has seasoned through. Insert the ThermoWorks leave-in probe into the breast of one bird — thickest part, tip centred, off the bone — and set the high alarm to ~150°F / 66°C.

ACTIVE COOKING

1. Roast (both birds), T-60. Oven fully at 450°F / 232°C. Set each bird on a **wire rack over a shallow tray**, side by side with a few cm gap. *The rack lets air circulate underneath so the skin crisps rather than steams; the tray catches the jus for basting and the carved breast. Do not sit the bird flat in a solid pan — the underside steams. Do not stack on a second rack. No basting, no added butter* — added fat steams and softens the skin.

2. Monitor by probe. The leave-in probe in the first bird alarms at ~150°F / 66°C — no need to check it repeatedly. When it nears the alarm, **spot-check the second bird's breast with the Thermopen**, since one leave-in probe watches only one bird and they may not finish together. *Skin should be fully browned by ~40 min for a ~1 kg bird; colour corroborates the probe.*

3. Out and rest, T-8. At breast temp, add thyme to the pan and give one baste with pan juices. Rest **uncovered** on a board, breast-up, 15 min. *Carve the dinner bird first; the lunch bird cools fully before refrigerating.*

Doneness (primary gate = breast): Pull when the breast reads 150–152°F / 66–67°C; carries to ~155°F / 68°C during the rest. Thighs read ~165–175°F / 74–79°C by then, correct for dark meat. Secondary cue: thigh-joint juices run clear; legs loose in the socket. If the breast is at temp but thigh juices run pink, tent only the legs and give 5 more min.

HOLDING & ASSEMBLY

Rest 15 min uncovered on a board (catches carving juices; tenting steams the skin). Remove twine. Carve per Keller: separate wing joints, remove legs and thighs, lift the oysters, split the breast down the middle and serve each half on the bone with a wing joint attached. **Slather the carved meat — not the skin — with fresh butter.** Spoon a little warm pan juice over the breast meat, avoiding the skin; reserve the rest for the table. Serve the lemon-Dijon vinaigrette *beside* the chicken, not over the skin. *Carve within ~3 min of serving so the skin doesn't soften.*

CRITICAL CONTROL POINTS

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
Critical	Skin steams instead of crisps — pale, flabby, no crackle.	Skin slack and blond after ~40 min in the oven.	Largely unrecoverable once roasted wet. Prevent: 18–24 hr uncovered dry-brine + re-pat dry + no in-roast basting + no tenting at rest + butter/juice on meat, not skin.

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
Major	Breast dries chasing thigh doneness. Unrecoverable for breast if pushed past; dish remains serviceable.	Breast climbs past 155°F / 68°C before the pull.	Pull on breast at 150–152°F, not the thigh; tent only the legs if they lag.
Major	Birds crowd the oven — touching or too close, they steam rather than crisp.	Pale, soft skin between the birds even as tops brown.	Roast side by side with a gap; if the Bosch can't fit both with clearance, roast the lunch bird after the dinner bird.
Major	Salt over-concentrates on a small bird.	Skin tastes sharply salty pre-roast.	Hold to ~9–10 g per bird; don't re-salt at T-65; unsalted butter at carving buffers.
Minor	Uneven browning — one side pale.	Visible at the browning check.	Rotate the pan; give 3–5 min more; acceptable cosmetic variance.

ADJUSTMENT NOTES

Adjustment	Guidance
Salt	If skin reads under-seasoned, a light finishing-salt pinch at carving recovers it — the dry-brine should prevent this.
Acid	If the jus tastes flat, a few drops of reserved lemon lift it.
Richness	Self-buffers at the table via butter, pan juices, and vinaigrette served separately.
Lunch bird	Cool fully uncovered before refrigerating; eats well cold next day (use-by 07/07, keep to Monday).

SCALING NOTES

Toward the top of the size range, add 5–10 min and verify by breast temp, not clock. Salt scales with weight — hold 0.8–1.0%. Do not dry-brine past ~30 hr on a small bird. Two birds need oven clearance between them; if unavailable, roast sequentially.

Anchovy Spaghetti

Serves 3 (2 restrained + 1 full) · Total ~15 min · Active ~15 min · Induction (both burners)

A garlic-and-anchovy oil sauce clinging to firm spaghetti, lifted with lemon juice, zest, and doubled parsley — the umami, acid, and freshness the austere chicken lacks. Salt kept low against the salted bird.

INGREDIENTS

Ingredient	Amount
Olive oil	4 tbsp / 60 ml
Garlic, large cloves, minced	4
Anchovy fillets, drained, chopped	6–8 fillets
Spaghetti	12 oz / 340 g
Fresh lemon	1½ tsp juice + zest of ½ lemon
Black pepper	to taste
Italian parsley, chopped	~6 tbsp (doubled)
Parmesan, grated	omit with this menu (see note)

PREP PHASE

Mince garlic. Chop 6–8 anchovies. Chop parsley (~6 tbsp). Zest ½ lemon; juice 1½ tsp. *All done during the chicken's roast so the rest window is pure execution.*

ACTIVE COOKING

Both induction burners run concurrently — pot boils on #1, oil base builds on #2. The base skillet becomes the finishing pan: off-heat before the pasta lands so the garlic doesn't re-fry.

1. Base (Induction #2, low). Heat oil, add garlic, cook gently 2 min — *pale gold, never brown*. Add anchovies; cook until garlic just begins to color, ~3 min, stirring so the fillets melt in. Pull **off-heat** — leave it in the skillet.

2. Pasta (Induction #1). Boil lightly salted water. Cook spaghetti firm-tender (just past the bite), ~9–10 min. Reserve ¼ cup / 60 ml pasta water before draining.

3. Finish in the skillet. With the skillet off-heat (or barely warm), transfer the drained pasta straight in. Add lemon juice + zest and a splash of pasta water. Toss vigorously to emulsify and coat. Pepper. *Should sheen and cling, not pool — add pasta water a splash at a time only if dry. The skillet must not be hot or the garlic turns bitter.*

4. Plate; parsley over the top.

HOLDING & ASSEMBLY

Do not hold. Finished last, plated last — toss and serve within ~1 min of draining. *Even 3–4 min of holding clumps the pasta and dulls the oil.* Omit Parmesan with this menu — chicken + anchovy + Parmesan stacks salt and umami with no upside; the pasta is a support act.

CRITICAL CONTROL POINTS

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
Critical	Garlic scorches — bitter, acrid oil. The oil is the sauce.	Garlic browns past gold, oil smells sharp; or pasta added to a hot skillet.	Keep base heat low; anchovies in at 2 min; skillet off-heat before the pasta lands. Unrecoverable once scorched.
Major	Sauce breaks / oily — no cling, oil pools on the plate.	Pasta greasy, sauce won't coat.	Add reserved pasta water a splash at a time, toss hard off-heat to re-emulsify the starch-oil bond.
Major	Over-salted from anchovy + salted water against the salted bird.	Aggressively salty on the plate.	Prevent: salt the water lightly, no sauce salt, no Parmesan. If salty, add lemon + parsley to cut.
Minor	Pasta overcooked / soft.	No bite.	Pull at firm-tender; it softens slightly in the hot toss.

ADJUSTMENT NOTES

Adjustment	Guidance
Salt	Withheld from the sauce — taste at the toss, correct only at the table given the salted bird. If flat rather than salty, a few drops of lemon before any salt.
Acid	Lemon at the toss; add a touch more to brighten if the dish reads heavy.

Adjustment	Guidance
Richness	Too lean or sharp → another tablespoon of the warm oil base; too rich → more lemon and parsley.

SCALING NOTES

Anchovy salt scales non-linearly — don't scale fillet count linearly on a bigger batch; taste at 1.5×. A wider skillet keeps garlic in a single layer and prevents scorch; crowded oil heats unevenly.

Bitter Leaf Salad, Lemon-Dijon Vinaigrette

Serves 3 · Total ~10 min · Active ~10 min · No heat

Cold, crisp mixed bitter leaves in a sharp lemon-Dijon vinaigrette — the meal's relief valve, cutting the chicken fat and oil-based pasta with bitterness and acid. Meal-level carve-out: this is the fresh/acid/crunch axis the two cooked components lack.

INGREDIENTS

Ingredient	Amount
Little gem	~2 heads, leaves separated
Frisée	~½ head, torn
Endive (Belgian)	1–2 heads, separated or halved (accent only)
VINAIGRETTE	
Dijon mustard	1 tbsp
Fresh lemon juice	1½ tbsp
Extra-virgin olive oil	4 tbsp / 60 ml
Diamond Crystal kosher salt	1 small pinch
Black pepper	to taste

PREP PHASE

Wash and thoroughly **dry** the leaves (a wet leaf won't hold dressing) at T-30; hold in the fridge. Tear frisée and larger leaves to bite size; keep little gem in short ribbons; separate endive leaves or halve lengthwise. Whisk the vinaigrette: Dijon + lemon first, then stream in the oil to emulsify; season with the pinch of salt and pepper. Hold at room temp. *Little gem for sweet crunch and body, frisée for delicate bitterness, endive as the crisp bitter accent — keep it a minority.*

ACTIVE COOKING

Not applicable — no heat. Assembly only.

HOLDING & ASSEMBLY

Keep leaves and vinaigrette **separate** until the last moment. At T-0, dress lightly — leaves just coated, not wet — toss, and plate immediately. *Reserve a little vinaigrette to spoon beside the chicken. Dress only what will be eaten; undressed spares keep, dressed leaves wilt within minutes.*

CRITICAL CONTROL POINTS

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
Major	Leaves dressed too early — wilted, soggy. Unrecoverable for wilted leaves; hold back undressed spares.	Leaves limp and weeping before serving.	Dress at T-0 only.
Minor	Vinaigrette split — oil separates.	Dressing looks broken, won't cling.	Re-whisk before dressing; the Dijon re-emulsifies it.
Minor	Over-dressed — heavy, oily leaves.	Dressing pools at the bowl base.	Dress lightly, in stages; serve extra on the side.

ADJUSTMENT NOTES

Adjustment	Guidance
Acid	If the plate reads rich, sharpen with a few drops of lemon; if too sharp against the wine, round with a little more oil.
Salt	Stays minimal; the Dijon and the meal's other salted components carry it.

SCALING NOTES

Vinaigrette holds the ~1½:4:1 lemon:oil:Dijon ratio at any volume. Dress-to-order regardless of batch size — never pre-dress expecting leftovers to hold.

Torched-Sugar Yogurt Pots, Odette Jam

Serves 3 · Total ~15 min + 20 min chill · Active ~10 min · Butane torch finish, no cook

Chilled tangy yogurt over a base of Odette dark-fruit jam, finished with a thin torched-sugar crust cracked at the table — a cool, tart-sweet reset after the rich savoury meal.

INGREDIENTS

Ingredient	Amount
Greek yogurt, full-fat	350 g / 1½ cups
Odette dark-fruit jam	6 tsp (2 tsp per pot)
Honey or icing sugar (to sweeten yogurt)	1–2 tsp, to taste (light)
Caster sugar (for brûlée crust)	~3 tsp (1 tsp per pot)
Lemon zest (optional finish)	a little

PREP PHASE

1. Stir the yogurt with honey/icing sugar to a light sweetness — *taste; it should stay tangy, not dessert-sweet. The jam carries the sweetness.*
2. Spoon 2 tsp jam into the base of each of three torch-safe ramekins; spread to cover.
3. Spoon ~115 g sweetened yogurt over the jam in each; level the surface flat. *A flat surface torches evenly.* Chill 20 min uncovered to firm the surface (holds up to 4 hr).

ACTIVE COOKING

No cook — butane torch finish only, to order. Do this after the mains have cleared, one pot at a time.

1. Sprinkle 1 tsp caster sugar in a thin, even layer across each chilled pot. *Use caster, not icing sugar — icing sugar scorches.*
2. Torch, moving continuously, until the sugar melts and turns amber. *Stop at deep gold — black flecks are bitter. Done when it stops bubbling and sets glassy-matte within a few seconds of pulling the flame away.*
3. Rest 1 min to harden into a crisp sheet. Finish with a little lemon zest if using.

HOLDING & ASSEMBLY

Assemble and chill up to 4 hr ahead — the surface holds. **Torch only at service:** the crust weeps and dissolves within ~15 min of contact with the cold yogurt. Serve immediately, cracking the crust at the table. *Torch one pot at a time; a torched pot cannot wait.*

CRITICAL CONTROL POINTS

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
Major	Sugar crust won't crisp — layer too thick, still syrupy. Unrecoverable if pooled; scrape and redo.	Stays wet, no glassy set after torching.	Sprinkle thin and even; torch longer with continuous motion.
Major	Torched too far — acrid, burnt.	Black flecks, bitter smell.	Stop at deep amber; keep the flame moving. Unrecoverable once burnt — wipe and re-sugar.
Minor	Yogurt weeps / watery surface.	Liquid pooling before torching.	Use thick full-fat Greek yogurt; pour off any whey before sugaring.

ADJUSTMENT NOTES

Adjustment	Guidance
Sweetness	If too sweet against the meal, the yogurt was over-sweetened — a few drops of lemon or zest pulls it back.
Acid / balance	If too tart, a thread more jam at the base rather than more sugar.
Texture	Keep the crust thin; it is contrast, not a sugar hit.

SCALING NOTES

Scales linearly by pot. Torch one pot at a time regardless of batch — the crust must be crisp at service. For more than ~4 pots, torch in the kitchen in quick succession rather than at the table.